# AUSTIN ZEPEDA

*Political Science, Business Administration Graduate*

## EDUCATION

Master of Science

Civic Analytics

**University of Illinois at Chicago**

Aug 2024 - current

Chicago, IL

Bachelor's of Arts

Political Science - Minors in Business Administration and Music

**Carthage College**

Conferred - May 2023

Kenosha, WI

**Yorkville High School**

Graduated May 2019

Yorkville, IL

## SKILLS

- R programming language, R Studio, and beginner Python.
- Public data expertise, policy analysis and program evaluation.
- Data collection, cleaning/processing, analysis, and visualization.
- Basic knowledge of SQL and relational databases.
- Knowledge of the data life cycle.
- Cross-functional communication.
- Timeliness and consistency.
- Aptitude for learning, engaging processes, and identifying KPIs after domain research.
- Bilingual, proficient in English and Spanish.

## OBJECTIVE

Public service professional seeking growth opportunities through a curiosity and passion for civic technology, data storytelling, and modernizing public data governance.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### Administrative Aide

**City of Aurora, IL**

Dec 2023 - current  Aurora, IL

- Supported the Chief Equity and Engagement Officer by coordinating initiatives that increased employee engagement by 25% YOY.
- Championed a data-driven culture and information-sharing across departments for staff engagement events, grant activities, and projects delegated by the Mayor's Office.
- Organized 100+ cultural and community engagement events, driving civic participation and city equity initiatives.
- Oversaw department payroll— immediately automated timekeeping practices to slash processing time and led the department's integration of UKG time solutions.
- Procurement and other financial procedures: created check requests, purchase orders, and sought grant opportunities.
- Managed departmental budget and reduced uncategorized expenditures by 90% YOY.
- Coordinated office operations for a team of 14—streamlining scheduling, managing employee records, and optimizing supply procurement.

### Revenue Agent LTE

**Wisconsin Department of Revenue**

Jan 2023 - Feb 2023  Kenosha, WI

- 80% of time spent engaged in customer service calls related to business tax concerns.
- 20% of time spent filing individual Homestead Credits. Became familiar with internal database and taxpayer online accounts, WINPAS and MyTaxAccount, respectively.
- Collaborated with a team of Revenue Agents to enhance customer satisfaction, serving 50+ clients daily at the front desk.
- Enhanced the protection of PII for Wisconsin residents by implementing 2FA in all customer interactions.

### Sales Associate - Interim Manager

**The UPS Store**

Jan 2020 - Sept 2021  Nashville, TN & Yorkville, IL

- Fulfilling customer orders, answering phones.
- Providing customer-centered service in a retail environment. Processed UPS insurance claims with a 100% success rate.

- Microsoft Office, including intermediate Excel and beginner Access.
- Attentive, poised, self-starting and motivated.

## ACTIVITIES

- Notary Public in State of IL.
- Mental Health First Aid certified
- Carthage Chorale
- Carthage College Student Government
- Belmont Office of Leadership Development (BOLD) program
- East Aurora Sports Boosters

- Skilled in international and domestic shipping procedures.
- Shipping packages, processing mail.
- Managing personnel and operations not limited to: payroll, scheduling, billing mailbox customers and other accounts, regular royalty reporting.

### Student Worker

**Belmont School of Occupational Therapy**

Aug 2019 - Apr 2020 Nashville, TN

- Performing office tasks such as taking phone calls, maintaining inventory of supplies, filing paperwork, and responding to the needs of faculty.
- Utilizing computer hard skills with the use of Microsoft Office.

### Supervisor

**Simply Destinee**

May 2019 - Jul 2019 Aurora, IL

- Performing supervisory responsibilities of dance camp staff, students, and the facility such as taking attendance, arranging transportation, managing the summer program.
- Curated a weekly report.

## PROJECTS

### Capstone Thesis

**For B.A. Political Science from Carthage College**

Sept 2022 - Dec 2022

- A descriptive essay on political polarization and its consequences for survey methodology and overall social science research. It explores facets of data collection, data quality, and inferences/theory building.